Country Hills Public School

School Council Meeting Minutes

June/18/2024 6:00 pm

Chair: Josh Windle

Member Attendance:

Present:

- Beth Creighton, Joanna Kneale
- Keiko App, Josh Windle, Kawaljeet Kaur, Ana Quintanilla, Tarra Stumpf. Becca Jayne, Bethany Leis, Karthik Shivkumar

Absent:

Robert Real, Ming Hui Huang, Courtney Lovell

Regrets:

Laura Eady, Aaron Fewkes, Jennifer Boyer

1. **Call to Order** – Josh Windle
2. **Territorial Acknowledgement** – Spoken by principal Mrs. Creighton
3. **Approval of Minutes of previous meeting** – Approved
4. **Approval/Additions to the Agenda** - Checked by Chair Mr. Windle and confirmed approved by all the council members
5. **Principal's Report** – Beth Creighton

Staffing changes
Mr. Tse and Mrs. Watts – moving to other school
Leave of absence – Mr. Fewkes, Mrs. Koza, Mrs. Nichols

Hiring for those positions will happen this week. Hopefully full staff by end of school
Monday, September 1st – School Day will post for families what class code your child placed in
3 KG class - 2 extended day class, 1 core day class
14 classes from Grade 1 to 6

6. **Educator Representative Reports** – Mrs. Joanna Kneale

Primary Update :

- Family engagement night enjoyed by the Country Hills community, with a very large turnout. Thanks to the leadership of Ms. Nichols & Mrs. McCleman.
- Kindergarten classes went on a field trip to Huron Natural area on May 17.
- Jump Rope for Heart event was held on May 30. Students enjoyed skipping, field games, sidewalk chalk colouring, prizes and great music. $663 was raised for the Heart & Stroke Foundation.
- "Welcome to School" event held on June 12 for incoming JK students and new SKs. Most families attended.
- This year's format was slightly different than in year's past but the event was beneficial to support transitions to school.

Junior Update :

- Track and Field at Country Hills occurred on May 13th - the weather held off for most of the day. Selected students attended the Jacob Hespeler area meet on May 29th; another great track and field season!
- "All About Me" Spirit Day was held on May 30, with many students wearing personal items of significance to them! Was great to see the individuality.
- Last spirit day = June 27 "Wear Red & White" - this is a tradition at Country Hills on the last day of school!
- EQAO ran from June 4-7 for grades 3 & 6 students.
- Grade 6 students visited Laurentian Public School to support successful transitions to grade 7.

Upcoming Updates:

- Talent Show = June 19 (Raindate = June 20). S
- NED Show Presentation = June 20. Character education assembly.
- Free-flow activity day = June 26.
- Last day of school = June 27

7. **Treasurer's Report –**

- Reported balance – $4705.53
- Mascot funding was removed.
- STEM kits are staying, were not used
- $434.55 left from $750 grant for family engagement night however expenses were not paid to families who spent on activities yet.

• You can't write cheques out of the grant amount
• Like to propose to reimburse families from either school council funds or Pic funds
• Pic fund - Last year was used for sign outdoor, this year not used.

Approved by Council

8. Sub-Committee Reports

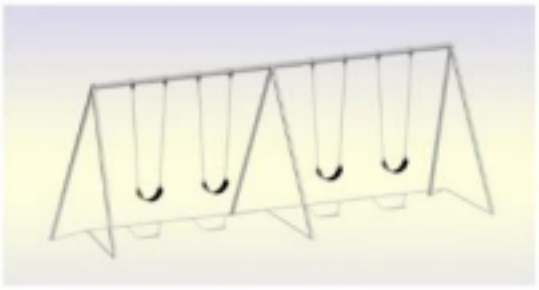
• WRAPSC Reports

Meeting attended by Tarra

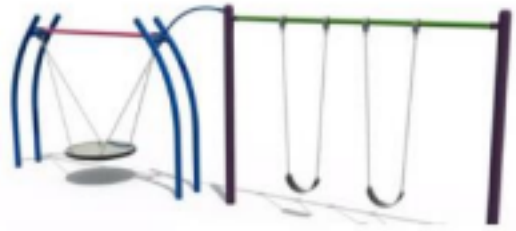
Meeting updates
About facilities
May 7 meeting
3 people from leadership
Facilities have new construction, refurbishing underway
Few outdoor things
It is not part of overall budget
They would not fund playgrounds
Board pays 0 for playground
We are not allowed to fundraise for things that board pays for
There is no such thing as approved vendors, they only have a contractor list Leaflets for fundraising – will have to be from contractors, also follow safety protocols 7-8 schools are phased out- new models coming
Lots of expansion happening
Improvements happening
Through region

Next meeting in September
Sends surveys
Invites speakers

• Fundraising Update – by Bethany
  - we can have swings from WRAPSC meeting
  - Accessible swing , rubber matting underneath – can apply grant
  - The hollow log in kindy area



$15,639



$28,699



Awaiting pricing

Target improvement areas to do in coming years

1. Restocking classroom outdoor bins – 2000
2. Gagaball pit – 4400
3. Swings – 14 to 28K , 2 sets , so double – 30 k at low end
4. Accesible seat , tarmac – 30K grant
5. Trees around outdoor classroom
6. Indoor equipments for inclement weather days

Sandpit not allowed unless accessible.
Idea to have 2 -one with accessible seat.
One with accessible seat and tarmac can be between kindy and primary .
Another at back of property – between trees and rocks
Gaga ball pit – not sure – if we need another one, or if we want to focus on other items
But can fit near outdoor classroom.
Ashphalt could be covered by board.
Painting of lines – our responsibility
Keiko suggested showing a map of swing locations to parents in a fundraising letter. 3D rendering, google maps – photo.
Josh could help with pricing.

Schools are a community space and not just for students.
Swings -require supervision, which might not always be available.
It's a safety concern to not have that kind of supervision.
Volunteers can be there but not always guaranteed. Something to consider before installing. Kids might not be able to use it sometimes due to this.

More fundraising ideas
-a-thon
Extra dollar to payments
Food cheques
Freezies

Family engagement night moved to earlier in the year.
How well it was received.
Grant might not be available that soon.
We don't know if it would be fundraising.
We do have a welcome back open house.
Council meeting in early September to figure out what needs to happen then.
Pizza days – help fundraise. If not available would use chocolates
Fun fair, raffle could be brought back.

Tarra asked the council again about swings at the end of the meeting and nobody said no. Josh suggested that swing needs to be accessible swing, Beth added the same.
Karthik – asked about payment in staggered manner

Grant – all money will not come in at once
By around June or July will be available

4500 sitting in account
Needs to be used
Don't think we would be questioned about why it is being saved, but we might.
Fundraising team can be left to make decisions.
We should be putting that together so by September if someone came in we can mention in checking
Allocating towards Tarmac games once done
Josh suggested – to mention – Making recess better Council project.
We allocate the current leftover balance.

Educator appreciation lunch on Thursday – 20th June 2024

Bylaws – proposing in next meeting.

School parent teacher meeting to be discussed later in coming meetings.

Open house -meet your teachers night – on Wednesday – in fall – 11th or 18th

Possibly 18th

Henna art suggested as fundraising event by Karthik, supported by Bethany

Tuesdays selected for future meeting

Gagaball pit, not very popul;ar in council so, will be at end of list for fundraising objective.

Mrs. Creighton will back 26th of August if anyone from council wants to share plans for anything before the first council meeting in September 2024.

9. Discussion Items

Spirit wear t shirt for children is coming as a fundraiser in fall

10.Future Meeting Dates

- Tuesdays
- Possibly first meeting will be held after the school open house